

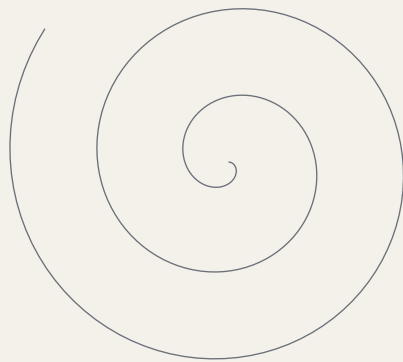


A V I V E R E A S T R A D O S S I E R

RIG

*The game played in the calm
at the heart of a spinning world.*

FOR THE GM'S CONSIDERATION · PROPOSED CANON
THE SPINDLE LEAGUE · NO CLOCK



*“It was just a thing tired people did on a long shift.
Then the chime didn’t stop.”*

— attributed, origin disputed, see §6

The Brief

This dossier proposes **rig** — a sport — as Vivere Astra canon. It is not set dressing. Rig is the argument that a scattered, frightened, post-collapse humanity, spread across stars it cannot see in real time, still does **one thing together on purpose, with no clock, for no reason except that the chime is still ringing.**

The case rests on three claims, each developed in full inside:

The venue is canon. O'Neill earmarked the weightless axis of the cylinder for recreation on the first napkin. We occupy a room the setting already built.

The physics is the game. The gravity gradient and the Coriolis asymmetry aren't flavor — they generate every rule, every position, every team's soul.

The economics is the setting's. Clockless, audio-first, Lira-denominated, jump-bottlenecked, governed by the one faction with no army. Rig's money is Vivere Astra's money.

A reader who finishes this can: follow a broadcast, explain why a **rise** is worth more than a **fall**, name the three GM hooks loaded into the economy, and seed a 32-team interstellar playoff. The companion artifact — a playable match in the calm — ships alongside.

The pitch in one line. Rig is what Vivere Astra's humans have instead of a shared sky.

The Physics — this is the sport

Sources swept and depth-read: the *npj Microgravity* trajectory paper (roulette-curve ball flight), Oikofuge's Coriolis guides, the canonical O'Neill cylinder, and Jon Bois' 17776 for tone. The full synthesis lives in the repository; here is what the physics **decided**.

The room the universe already built

A regulation cylinder is ~ 6.4–8 km across, 32 km long, spun ~ 28 times an hour for one gravity at the rim — and the long axis down its center stays **weightless**. Riggers call that volume **the calm**: a windless, weightless tube tens of kilometers long, a few hundred meters across, with the far land curving up overhead and nothing falling at the center.

The three facts that are the whole game

The slope you spend Effective weight rises smoothly from zero at the axis to full at the rim. Distance from the axis is a **resource**. Drop rimward — **deep** — for power, speed, commitment; the slope gives no refunds. Float axisward — **high** — for time, options, reversibility, and softness. Coaches say it in three words: **deep is faithful, high is free**.

The cruel hand A spinning world deflects everything that flies. Thrown **with** the spin (**fair**), the bell arcs about how your gut expects. Thrown **against** it (**cross**), the bell **rises, curves hard, and can sail clear around a bend** before it comes down. The whole sport is lopsided around this — one goal is honest and cheap, the other is against the grain and dear.

You cannot fly In the calm there is no swimming or cutting. You change vector exactly two ways: push off something solid, or throw a line and haul. Every rigger carries a powered tether-and-claw — a grapple, descended from the construction lines the game was born on. Rig is a grappling-hook sport at the bones. The hook is the only reason humans can play at all.

*Ball flight in the calm follows **roulette curves** — involutes and Archimedean spirals (the motif on every page of this dossier is not decoration; it is a thrown bell). The closed-arc **loop** — a throw that curves back to the hand untouched — is real, and it is the founding trick and the seven-point score.*

The Sport

Rig: two crews in the calm; the formal league name is the **Spindle League**; a match is **a rig**; you **rig up**; a player is **a rigger**.

The field, the bell, the crew

A regulation field is **640 m** of the calm between two **goal rings**, sleeved by a soft mesh **skin**; touch it and you are **skinned** (out). Down the axis run fixed **spars** (clip-points); three notional **gates** — **first, deep, mouth** — divide it. The two ends are unequal by rule: the **Faith** end is attacked **with** the spin (honest, heavier, easier); the **Free** end **against** it (rarer, dearer). **Choosing ends is the deepest strategic decision in the sport.**

The **bell** is a dense soft sphere that **rings** when it spins true and **clatters** when it tumbles — read by ear, which is why rig broadcasts on audio across light-years. Six a side, free substitution at any dead bell. Positions are **radius jobs**, not field positions:

POS	NAME	JOB
1	Anchor	Deep & heavy. Power and last defense. Never floats.
2	Spinners ×2	Midfield engine. Trade altitude for tempo; run the lines; set loop plays. The league’s best.
2	Wings ×2	A Faithwing (power, fair side) and a Freewing (the artist; cross side — the franchise’s signature name).
1	Reach	Goal-ring keeper. May clip and pivot on the ring. Sport’s lunatics.

How play runs — casts, counts, innings

A possession is a **cast** (football’s downs, in 3D, with radius as a free extra axis): three throws to clear the next gate, or turn it over. Football moves the bell; **baseball decides it**. The instant a defender contests a bell in flight, play freezes into a one-on-one — **a one** — on **the count** of three exchanges: complete, or **snatch** or **clatter** for a turnover **at that radius and direction**. A one fought deep is fast, violent, final; fought high it is slow, reversible, chess. The slope is **inside** the duel. A rig box score is a wall of one-on-one lines — the stat-haunted baseball soul, in flight.

A match is **nine innings**. Tie → **spine**: sudden-death casts at the Free end, against the world’s hand, forever. There is no clock. There has never been a clock. Three commissioners died proposing one; the league counts this as a rule.

Scoring

SCORE	WORTH	WHAT IT IS
Fall	2	Bell through the Faith (fair) ring. The honest score. The bread.
Rise	5	Through the Free (cross) ring, into the world’s wrong-handed curve. Most riggers never score one in a season.

SCORE	WORTH	WHAT IT IS
Loop	7	Score with a closed Coriolis arc — bell untouched in flight, bent home on the world's own math. Ends the inning. The home run, the no-hitter, and the Hail Mary fused. The crowd goes silent to hear if the bell still rings.
Ground	1	(to the defense) Force an attacker into the skin. The grinding soul of great defensive habitats.

The Rules in Brief & The Glossary

Enough to follow a match — not the Reg (ten thousand pages, three dead commissioners). The six ideas a newcomer **must** be told, because they have no Earth equivalent:

*The calm — the field is a **volume**, not a plane: the weightless axis of a spun world.*

The slope — gravity rises rim-ward; your radius is a resource you continuously spend.

*The asymmetry — the two goals are physically different. Honest cheap **Fall** vs. against-the-grain dear **Rise**.*

*The Coriolis loop — thrown things bend, and a **cross** throw can fly a closed arc home. The 7.*

*The line — no flight in zero-g; the grapple is the **only** mobility. Rig is a hook sport.*

Reading by ear — the bell rings true, clatters tumbled; hearing is the deciding sense, hence audio-cast.

Fouls, short list

Garrote — a live line across a flight path; the cardinal sin, ejection. **Cording** — wrapping a line on a body/line; turnover+advance. **Skinning** — driving a player into the skin; turnover, repeat ejects. **Crowding the Reach** — contacting a clipped keeper; free throw from the mouth. **Slow bell** — stalling to run a clock that **does not exist**; a foul, because pretending there is a clock is heresy.

The simplification pass (the user’s note, honored)

A designed term and a **shouted** term are different objects. Left is what the Reg calls it; right is the blunt monosyllable a rigger yells mid-flight across a bad audio gap. The bluntness is itself canon — the riggers’ fingerprint on the language.

ON PAPER	SHOUTED	NOTE
antispinward / against the spin	cross	the glamour word
spinward / with the spin	fair	the honest side
rimward / toward the skin	deep	“take it deep”
axisward / toward the axis	high	“high and free”
the Faithful goal / Free goal	Faith / Free	“they’re a Free team”
a contest / one-on-one	a one	“won the one”
make the bell tumble	clatter	defense’s oldest cry

ON PAPER	SHOUTED	NOTE
take it clean	snatch	“snatched at the mouth”
Faithwing / Freewing	the Faith / the Free	a star Free is “their Free”
grounded into the skin	skinned	“he got skinned”
extra spine / overtime	spine	“going to spine”
the Spindle Regulation	the Reg	rig’s metric system
a regulation match	a rig	“good rig tonight”

The Economics

Rig's money is strange in exactly the way the setting is strange — and every line is a GM hook.

The revenue stack

1. **Call rights — the biggest line.** A live system-to-system feed is physically impossible (light-speed). Rig sells **the call, not the game**, and the **re-call** — a system's own famous voice re-performing a jumped-in match from the chime log days later — is the single highest-rated media product in human space. Rig's broadcast is a **cover version**, and that is normal.
2. **The gate, by radius band.** Seats priced along the gradient: heavy, cheap, loud rim-band (the soul) up to weightless axis boxes (the money, where deals get done). The stadium's price gradient **is** the field's gradient.
3. **Certification & the Reg.** The Concordat-kept body charges habitats to certify regulation spindles and audits the reference value. Small money, enormous power.
4. **The in-play market, in Lira.** No clock means no garbage time and no kneeling the bell — every cast is live value. Rig is the substrate of the largest legal in-play wagering market in the settled systems, denominated in **Lira** because the Lira already runs in the seams between everyone's flags. Rig betting is a real fraction of why the Concordat's currency stays liquid where its flag never flies.

The costs — where the campaign hooks live

Travel is the budget. A road trip is an O-drive jump: exotic matter, weeks down, real Jump cost. A schedule is a colonial supply line. A road trip can be a lead.

The spindle is a soft target. A sabotaged regulation spindle is a dark stadium and a humiliated faction with no publicized death. NISO treats it as infrastructure security.

Riggers are dual-use talent. A great Freewing thinks in Coriolis the way aggies thought in everything. Rig academy → astronautics corps → (for a quiet few) France, or Ananke.

The shape, in one line: rig is clockless, audio-first, Lira-denominated, jump-bottlenecked, governed by the faction with no army — Vivere Astra's economics with a bell in them. That is the argument for canon.

The Spindle League — 32

Franchises

Style is not chosen; it is **spun in**. Big slow cylinders breed patient **Fall** power; small fast stations breed **Rise** chaos; mid cylinders breed the **ground** line broker game. Faction key: **FRM** Frontier Republic of Michigan · **CNE** Commonwealth of New England · **CON** the Concordat · **BLT** Belt independents · **EUR** Old-Europe diaspora · **REF** the governing body.

Sol Conference — “First Spin”

Tuebor Spin Detroiters #1 27–6 · FRM · Fall dynasty The sport’s dynasty. Granite Anchor, the honest 2 ground out a hundred times. Neutrals are bored; Tuebor spins on.	Boston Commons Reach #2 24–9 · CNE · Line Tuebor vs. Commons is the great rivalry — Fall dynasty vs. line craft, Frontier vs. Commonwealth.
Roma Aeterna Brokers #3 23–10 · CON · Ground/away The infuriating broker rig. Wins road trophies nobody enjoys watching. The Lira travels; so do its fans.	Manchester Memorial #5 22–11 · CNE · Grief Exists as remembrance. Every match opens on a silent bell. When they run, even Frontier crowds stand.
Cascade Works Foremen #11 21–12 · FRM · Fall grind Blue-collar, clatter-heavy. They make your bell ring ugly. Loudest rim-band in the league.	Lira Free Company #14 20–13 · CON · Adaptive No home, by design — rents calm wherever the Lira runs. Belt operators fly it as a flag of convenience.
Saginaw Bell — 18–15 · FRM · Fall tempo The connoisseur’s team. Cleanest passing in Sol; scores least dramatically.	Veracity Yard Probes — 16–17 · FRM · Loop eng. Built the Veracity probe; does Coriolis math for fun. Lost a play-in on a clattered bell. Gallows humor.

Plymouth Counter

#—

CNE Sol mid cylinder

■ ■ 20–13 · CON-adj · Line

Old Commonwealth money, very smug, deservedly. Brutal Reach play.

New Haven Ear

#—

CNE — officiating academy

■ ■ 19–14 · CNE · Legalist

They train the Ears, then win the Ears' calls. Everyone hates this. It is canon.

Vatican Spindle

—

Concordat ceremonial home club

■ ■ 17–16 · REF · Ceremony

Institution more than contender. The joke writes itself; the joke is load-bearing, like the Lira.

Trieste Counterweight

—

Concordat secondary Sol cylinder

■ ■ 15–18 · CON · Defensive

The Concordat's farm of brokers. Dull. Effective.

The Near Reach — “First Light”

Toliman Gradient

#8

Alpha Cen B — small fast station

■ ■ 25–8 · FRM · Rise chaos

Proved the colonies could beat Sol. Its Freewing is the most famous rigger alive. Feral, sleepless, evangelical.

Tau Ceti Mare Nostrum

#4

Concordat flagship colony — balanced

■ ■ 24–9 · CON · Broker

The Concordat's **real** contender. Plays for the away point and the draw and wins the Jump doing it.

Luhman Orbital Riot

#6

FRM Luhman 16 — born from the riot

■ ■ 23–10 · FRM · Rise/pol

A labor movement that learned to score. The most dangerous low seed. France-watchers watch this fanbase.

Hebat Resolve

#9

CNE Fomalhaut — the bombed colony

■ ■ 22–11 · CNE · Defiant

Sister-grief to Manchester. Their meetings are the most-listened rig in human space. Ananke eyes the spindle.

Centauri b Hammerline

#10

FRM Alpha Cen colony — mid-fast

■ ■ 21–12 · FRM · Rise power

Out-produces the Concordat; plays like it knows. Wins 7s by force.

Wolf 359 Migration

#15

CNE Wolf 359 — near Tartarus

■ ■ 20–13 · CNE · Rise flock

Whole crews move like the macrofauna in Tartarus's clouds. The most coordinated high game in the league.

Fomalhaut Dagon Wake

#—

CNE Fomalhaut — in sight of dead Dagon  19–14 · CNE · Haunted

Plays under what an RKV did to a living world. NISO dislikes keeping Dagon in front of 40,000 a night.

Gliese 65 Twinstar

—

CNE binary-system colony  18–15 · CNE · Line

Balanced line. Two suns, two interlocked rings.

Proxima Long Shift

—

FRM Proxima outpost — brutal station  17–16 · FRM · Rise

Plays like the shift that invented the game never ended. Frontier romance incarnate.

Lacaille Longjump

—

CNE deeper colony  16–17 · CNE · Travel

Always the away team; ground rig, travel-hardened.

82 Eridani Secondi

—

Concordat secondary colony  15–18 · CON · Junior

The Concordat's far farm of brokers.

Frontier Veracity Deep

—

FRM deep colony — Centauri edge  17–16 · FRM · Fall

Isolated, stubborn, far. The edge of the push.

The Far Reach & the Belt — “Deep Jump”

Kuiper Long Call

#7

Deepest, darkest Belt franchise  22–11 · BLT · Audio ground

Out where the broadcast **is** the team. Their re-call is the highest-rated media in human space. Richest “small” club.

Belt Free Local 9

#12

Belt independent, syndicate-run  21–12 · BLT · Rise lunatic

The purest chaos rig. Half the league's best came up here — **and some people the league won't name.**

Ceres Counterspin

#13

Belt's largest hub station  20–13 · BLT · Contrarian

Attacks the **Free** end by preference — the most expensive way to play — because Belters are like that.

Vesta Tool-Bag Originals

#16

Belt — claims oldest folk-rig lineage  18–15 · BLT · Ceremonial

“WE THREW THE FIRST LOOP.” Every origin-myth argument routes through Vesta's marketing department.

Eros Garrote

#—

Belt — the beloved villains

19–14 · BLT · Dirty

Foul-prone, magnetic, the team you boo and can't stop hearing. Best road-call ratings in the league.

Silesia Exiles

#—

Old-Europe diaspora (ASHFIELD descendants)

19–14 · EUR · Mournful

Old Europe's only seat at the table. The neutral's favorite. A bridge between Kanzo's campaigns.

Luhman 16 Browline

—

FRM Luhman brown-dwarf system

17–16 · BLT-adj · Rise

Low-light audio legends — broadcasts better than it looks.

The Reference Eleven

#—

Governing body's neutral all-star side

exh. · REF · Platonic

Plays only the reference spin nobody's home uses. No fans by birth, only by belief. The Reg in a jersey.

The Jump — Current Playoff Seeding

We are on the eve of the Jump: the top 16 cross into interstellar single-elimination. Higher seed hosts on its certified spindle; **the lower seed pays the jump** (exotic matter + weeks of transit) — travel is the bracket’s hidden bracket, per canon.

SEED	TEAM	FAC	REC	STYLE
1	Tuebor Spin Detroiters	FRM	27–6	Fall dynasty
2	Boston Commons Reach	CNE	24–9	Line
3	Roma Aeterna Brokers	CON	23–10	Ground/away
4	Tau Ceti Mare Nostrum	CON	24–9	Broker
5	Manchester Memorial	CNE	22–11	Ground (grief)
6	Luhman Orbital Riot	FRM	23–10	Rise (political)
7	Kuiper Long Call	BLT	22–11	Audio ground
8	Toliman Gradient	FRM	25–8	Rise chaos
9	Hebat Resolve	CNE	22–11	Ground (defiant)
10	Centauri b Hammerline	FRM	21–12	Rise power
11	Cascade Works Foremen	FRM	21–12	Fall grind
12	Belt Free Local 9	BLT	21–12	Rise lunatic
13	Ceres Counterspin	BLT	20–13	Rise contrarian
14	Lira Free Company	CON	20–13	Adaptive ground
15	Wolf 359 Migration	CNE	20–13	Rise flock
16	Vesta Tool-Bag Originals	BLT	18–15	Ceremonial Rise

Seeding note. Toliman is 25–8 yet seeded 8: the Jump weights **strength of jump** — wins over teams that had to cross interstellar distance to reach you count less than wins earned on the road. The Concordat designed the tiebreak. Of course they did.

First-round storylines the calls will sell

1 Tuebor v 16 Vesta — the dynasty vs. the origin myth. “We defend” vs. “we threw the first loop.” Whoever loses, marketing wins.

5 Manchester v 12 Belt Free Local 9 — the grief franchise vs. the dual-use talent fountain. NISO has people in both rim-bands. A lead waiting to happen.

6 Luhman Orbital Riot v 11 Cascade Works — the riot vs. the foremen, on national audio, France-backed-riot optics. Kanzo can light this fuse anytime.

8 Toliman v 9 Hebat — chaos vs. grief, the two best low seeds, the connoisseur's pick for rig of the year.

Off the Board — hooks the league won't print

The Directorate Circuit. France's breakaway pariah league — O-drive-funded, an aesthetic of **forced Rises** the Spindle League calls decadent. Runs its own spin, rejects the reference. Recognizing the Circuit is a diplomatic act; a rigger who jumps to it has **defected**.

The talent pipeline. Rig academy → astronautics corps → for a quiet few, France or Ananke. The best Freewings think in Coriolis the way aggies used to think in everything. The league's unspoken anxiety is the campaign's, with a jersey on.

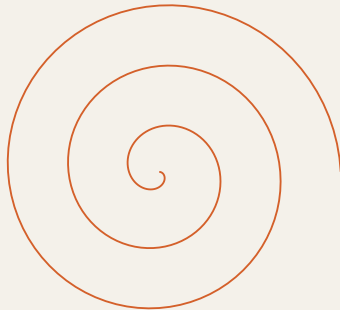
The Ananke question. Ananke has tried for a championship spindle once. The league does not discuss it. NISO does not either. The reader is told only this much — on purpose (17776's witnessing restraint, as a plot device).

Certification as recognition. A new colony's first certified spindle says it **belongs**. A spindle lost to sabotage or riot is a bloodless humiliation on interstellar audio. Every certification is a small treaty. Hand to the GM.

Bibliography & Colophon

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Set in New Computer Modern. Spirals are computed Archimedean roulettes — every one is a thrown bell. Built with Typst. **NO CLOCK**



The chime is still ringing.